This mistrust was not one-sided. In general, the US had been praising Pakistan for its cooperation in the war on terrorism. On eve of the tenth anniversary of 9/11 (11 September 2011), President Obama's press secretary Jay Carney said, 'It (US–Pakistan) is an important relationship and it is complicated as I have said numerous times from the podium, but America and Americans are safer because of the cooperation we have been able to achieve with Pakistan.' On the contrary, a few higher officials of the US government criticised Pakistan for deficient cooperation. The US Vice President Joe Biden called Pakistan an 'unreliable ally' in the campaign. While talking to the CNN on the tenth anniversary of 9/11, he alleged that Pakistan failed 'on the occasion' when forced to choose between the US and Al Qaeda, which caused loss of life of American soldiers in Afghanistan. Hillary Clinton had been urging Pakistan to do more. While in Kabul on 20 October 2011, she threatened that it was a time for Islamabad to decide whether it would help or hinder the US-led war against militants. On the next day, she reached Islamabad, accompanied with top US military and Intelligence officials, and reiterated the above stance. In return, the Prime Minister of Pakistan, Syed Yousuf Raza Gillani, during his meeting with Hillary Clinton, called upon the US to give peace a chance as envisaged in the resolution adopted by the All Parties Conference held in Pakistan after the row over the Haqqani network issue (*The Nation*, 2011).

This blame-game caused an ever-widening gulf of mistrust and distrust. Emphasising on 'winning back the trust of allies', a report in *The Economist* suggested to the US, 'The trick in the next ten years would be to win back the trust of allies (especially Pakistan)' (*Economist,* 2011). Conversely, the trust of allies was badly bruised when the Pak-US relations took a further nosedive after the NATO gunship helicopters intruded into the Pakistan territory and attacked a checkpost (Salala) in Bajaur Agency, KP, resulting in the death of 26 soldiers including a major and a captain. Pakistan reacted by stopping the NATO supply route and demanded an apology from the US over killing of its soldiers. The tussle prolonged as the US refused to apologise and Pakistan did not open the supply route. The increase in the bitterness in the Pak-US relations could be judged from the fact that in September 2010, the US had apologised on a similar incident and Pakistan opened the route. However, it resulted in the destruction of almost 100 oil tankers and